E3 Reading – The Camping Group – Mock Reading Paper

Name: _____ Date: _____ Score: ___ / 18

Time: 60 minutes. Read each text, then answer the questions.

Task 1 – The Camping Group

Read the text and answer questions 1–9.

A group of men has been camping together for nearly thirty years. The group started in the mid-1990s and goes camping almost every year. About twelve men are regular members, though the number changes sometimes. They visit different parts of the UK. Atin has been part of the group for ten years and rarely misses a trip.

The men enjoy long walks in the countryside. Walks are often between five and fifteen miles. They walk up mountains and along country paths. The walks are not technically difficult, but they are quite challenging because of their length. The men usually complete their walks and then go to a local pub for rest and food.

At the pubs, the men drink beer and eat lunch or dinner. They stay for several hours and play cards. The pubs are always different because the group visits different places. The men enjoy spending time together and having silly conversations about football. Sometimes they eat at the campsite instead of a pub.

For Atin, the main appeal is the countryside and nature. He enjoys waking up in nature, away from the city. He also values the friendship and the chance to let his hair down with his friends. Most years he feels tired before the trip, but he is usually glad he went when he returns home.

The group usually chooses places with good campsites. These are important for the group's comfort and enjoyment. A good campsite with peace and quiet makes the experience special.

1. When did the camping group start?

A In the 1980s
B In the mid-1990s
C In the early 2000s
D In 2015

2. What makes the walks challenging?

A They involve steep mountain climbs
B They are long, but not very difficult
C The weather is always bad
D The paths are poorly marked

3. Why do they go to pubs after their walks?

A To shelter from bad weather
B To rest and have a meal
C To meet other walkers
D To get directions

4. Put these events in order. Number 1 has been done for you.

__1__ The men walk in the countryside
_____ They play cards
_____ They go to a pub
_____ They have something to eat and drink

5. What does "let his hair down" mean?

A Cut his hair short
B Relax and enjoy himself
C Wash his hair
D Take off his hat

6. The text is mainly about

A how to plan a camping trip
B a long-running group and why it matters to them
C the best campsites in the UK
D why walking is good for your health

7. Write these words in alphabetical order.

camping country caravan challenging card

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____ 4 _____ 5 _____

8. Why does Atin rarely miss a trip?

A He lives closest to the campsites
B He has no other hobbies
C The trips matter to him, even when he is tired
D He organises the trips

9. What does the last paragraph tell you about how the group chooses campsites?

A They choose the cheapest sites
B They choose sites that are comfortable and quiet
C They choose sites at random
D They only camp in the mountains

Task 2 – The Festival Campsite

Read the text and answer questions 10–18.

This year, the camping group went to a new place. They arrived on Friday afternoon and put up their tents at the campsite. The walk on Saturday was good and they all enjoyed the countryside. They went to a pub in the evening, had a drink and played cards until late.

When they got back to the campsite that night, Atin realised there was a problem. The campsite had changed. It was now a trendy place for young people who wanted to party. There was loud music and noise until the early morning. This was very different from what the group wanted. They prefer peace and quiet in nature.

The campsite had other problems too. There were only portaloos, which are small portable toilets. Atin does not like these. They are uncomfortable and not pleasant. The whole place felt like a small music festival, not a peaceful camping trip.

The group still tried to enjoy the weekend. The walks were beautiful and the countryside was lovely. The men played cards, talked and ate together.

However, Atin felt frustrated. For him, the special part of camping is waking up in nature, with peace and quiet. This campsite did not offer that. He was not as happy with this trip as he usually is.

Next year, the group will need to find a better campsite. The place and its facilities are very important to the group's enjoyment.

10. What is a portaloo?

A A toilet in a pub
B A small portable toilet
C A luxury bathroom
D A shower block

11. How did Atin feel about the portaloos?

A He thought they were modern
B He found them unpleasant
C He preferred them to normal toilets
D He wanted to use them more

12. Which sentence about the Saturday walk is true?

A The group found it boring
B The group enjoyed the countryside
C The group decided to leave early
D The group played cards instead

13. Put these events in order. Number 1 has been done for you.

__1__ The group arrives on Friday afternoon
_____ Atin realises the campsite has changed
_____ They go for a walk
_____ They go to a pub in the evening

14. What is most important to Atin about camping?

A Playing cards with friends
B Going to pubs
C Being in nature, with peace and quiet
D Getting exercise

15. The text is mainly about

A how to choose a good campsite
B how a noisy campsite spoiled the group's weekend
C why young people like festivals
D why portaloos are uncomfortable

16. Write these words in alphabetical order.

weekend walk when would weather

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____ 4 _____ 5 _____

17. What did the group still do, despite the problems?

A They complained to the owners
B They walked, played cards and spent time together
C They went home early
D They stopped eating together

18. What will the group probably do next year?

A Stop camping
B Go back to the same campsite
C Keep camping, but choose a better campsite
D Ask for the campsite to be closed